Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree, currently an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning with the City of Toronto. Builds the datasets and dashboards that turn travel data into evidence for decisions, and writes the reports and briefing notes that carry it to senior staff.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.
- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python, including a ROW-width dataset covering all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Spatial analysis of large transportation datasets in GIS, turning data into recommendations for safer wildfire evacuation plans in Alberta communities.

SKILLS

Spatial and statistical analysis of transportation data. Data validation and dashboards. ArcGIS Pro, QGIS and MapBox. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and JavaScript. Synchro, VISSIM, OpenTrack and MATSim. Technical reports and briefing notes.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022. CGPA 4.0/4.0; fully funded by the university.

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018. CGPA 3.69/4.0; University Merit Scholarship, University Stipend Scholarship, Technical Scholarship, Dean's List.

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)